

## SORE THROAT/HOARSENESS, A-1

A sore throat is often due to a viral infection. Bacterial infections and other causes need to also be considered.

**Red Flags.** If the Soldier presents with any of the red flags, immediately disposition the Soldier as “Provider Now.” One-sided severe sore throat with fever, trouble swallowing as shown by drooling, uvula displacement, hoarseness (hot potato voice), trismus (lock jaw), and enlarged, tender tonsils are signs of a deep neck space infection like a peritonsillar abscess. Shortness of breath and stridor are signs of upper airway obstruction due to severe pharyngeal inflammation.

DP1. Symptoms greater than 10 days, immunosuppression, inhaled steroid medications are related to diseases that are unlikely to go away without treatment. Hoarseness longer than 2 weeks requires a full laryngeal exam.

DP2. 4 questions that look at the chance of having a Group A Streptococcal (GAS) infection. If 3 of the questions are positive, there is 32% chance of having GAS and a rapid antigen test (RADT) should be performed. The RADT is effective for ruling out GAS in adults but some Soldiers with GAS are missed. Culture test is performed when the RADT is negative and Soldiers or their contacts are at higher risk for complications from a GAS infection. Culture generally takes 24-48 hours for the results to return.

## TREATMENT PROTOCOL, A-1

Other protocols. Sore throat and hoarseness that are associated with a virus should be treated with minor-care. The other symptoms should be treated according to their associated protocols.

MCP for sore throat. A sore throat is often due to a viral infection. Minor-care consist of pain control, measures to decrease inflammation, getting plenty of rest and drinking plenty of fluids (water). Return for signs of the infection getting worse or progressing.

MCP for hoarseness. Hoarseness is often due to a virus or irritant. Minor-care consists of resting the vocal cords and avoidance of irritants (cigarette smoking, yelling, heartburn, post-nasal drip). This is a good opportunity to discuss the negative effects of tobacco use and encourage the Soldier to quit using tobacco, if applicable.

| A-1: In accordance with MEDCOM Regulation 40-50 |                                                           |              |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Obtain a Throat Culture                         | pg.68                                                     | (13)         |
| A-1: In accordance with STP 8-68W13-SM-TG Task  |                                                           |              |
| Subject Area 6: Primary Care                    | Perform a head, eyes, ears, nose, and throat (HEENT) Exam | 081-833-0254 |
| Subject Area 6: Primary Care                    | Provide Care for Common Throat Infections                 | 081-833-0243 |
| Subject Area 15: Primary Care (SL2)             | Obtain a Throat Culture                                   | 081-833-0248 |

## SORE THROAT/HOARSENESS, A-1

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| <b>Partial Differential Diagnosis</b><br>Viral Infections<br>Bacterial Infections<br>Meningitis<br>Neck Deep Tissue Infection<br>Candida Infection<br>Strep Throat | <b>RED FLAGS</b><br>Shortness of Breath<br>Stridor<br>Deviated Uvula<br>Drooling/Trouble Swallowing<br>Stiff Neck | Activity Modification:<br>None |
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